BWIZA JEWELS

From one bracelet to a new way of thinking about accessories

PITCH DOCUMENT

Prepared for Nazli Tech School

2026

The idea started with a bracelet.

I did not start Bwiza Jewels because I wanted to make another bracelet. I started by asking a simpler question: can something small, beautiful and made from natural materials carry more value than just its appearance?

That question led me to the Umwenya concept and to a bamboo prototype. The first product is a bracelet, but the idea has already grown beyond it. I see a future where the same thinking can create earrings, necklaces, bands, beaded pieces, aromatized jewelry, personalized gifts and other accessories made from bamboo, organic beads and other organic materials.

The bracelet is the beginning of Bwiza Jewels, not the finish line.

What makes Bwiza Jewels different

The current prototype brings together qualities that are usually treated separately. It is cultural, aesthetic, natural and potentially functional. The bamboo gives us a starting material; the design gives it identity; and the business model gives it a reason to exist beyond a one-time souvenir purchase.

A one-of-a-kind feel: the handmade nature of the product gives each piece room for character and variation.

Cultural value: designs can tell a Rwandan story instead of looking like a generic souvenir.

Sustainability: the current concept targets around 90% biodegradability, depending on the final materials and finishing used.

Function: some bracelet designs can be developed with mosquito-repellent properties for outdoor settings, subject to proper testing and validation.

Choice: multiple designs allow the product to serve different tastes, ages and occasions.

Who is it for?

Tourists are an important market, but they are not the whole market. Bwiza Jewels is intended for people who want to wear, give or keep something that feels connected to Rwanda and to a more natural way of making accessories.

Local customers looking for everyday accessories and meaningful gifts

Tourists looking for memorable souvenirs

Hotels and lodges looking for welcome gifts or gift-shop products

National parks and outdoor tourism businesses for souvenirs and selected functional products

Airports and travel retail for locally inspired gifts

Companies, schools and event organizers for personalized bands and gifts

Cultural destinations, craft stores and other visitor-focused businesses

Where the product can go

Today A bamboo Umwenya bracelet prototype with multiple design possibilities.

Next A wider Bwiza Jewels collection using bamboo, organic beads and other organic materials.

With funding Better finishing, packaging, more designs, personalization, aromatized jewelry and stronger product testing.

With technology Selected accessories can carry QR codes that connect people to event registration, photo archives, cultural stories, digital certificates or other useful information.

Long term A recognizable sustainable accessories brand with the ambition to replace plastic bands with attractive organic alternatives wherever the product can perform the same job.

Technology will not replace the craft. It will extend it.

A Bwiza Jewels product can stay completely physical while still having a digital life. For example, a company could give guests personalized bands at an event. A QR code on the band could lead to registration details, an event photo archive or a page with the story of the event. A hotel could use the same idea for a welcome gift. A tourism product could link visitors to information about a destination or the story behind the accessory.

This creates an opportunity for me to bring my technology background into the business: not by putting unnecessary electronics into jewelry, but by using software to make a physical product more useful and memorable.

Why the Nazli Tech School ecosystem matters

Bwiza Jewels is being developed through the Nazli Tech School environment. The schools connection with Women in Tech Rwanda also creates a potential route to mentorship,

networking, visibility and introductions to people and organizations that could help a young venture learn how to enter the market.

I would especially value support in three areas: connecting with potential business partners, learning how to market the product professionally, and meeting people who can help turn a promising prototype into a real small business.

The goal is to use the ecosystem as a bridge to opportunities, while building the business on its own products and value.

How Bwiza Jewels can make money

The business can grow through a mix of individual sales and partnerships rather than depending on one customer type.

Retail sales to local customers and tourists

Wholesale supply to hotels, lodges, airports, parks and gift shops

Personalized orders for companies and events

Welcome-gift packages for hospitality businesses

Premium collections using organic beads, aromatization or special designs

Future digital services connected to QR-enabled products

What I need to take it further

The purpose of funding is not simply to make more bracelets. It is to prove that the idea can become a repeatable product business.

Improve and test the bamboo prototype

Develop a small collection instead of a single design

Test materials, durability, comfort and the functionality of repellent variants

Develop packaging and a clear Bwiza Jewels identity

Experiment with organic beads and other organic materials

Develop personalization and aromatized product options

Build a simple QR-linked digital experience for selected products

Pilot sales and partnerships with real customers and businesses

What I want Bwiza Jewels to become

I want Bwiza Jewels to grow into a brand that people can recognize, not just a product they buy once. The goal is to make sustainable accessories attractive enough that people choose them because they look good and carry meaning, not only because they are described as environmentally friendly.

Starting with bamboo, the brand can gradually explore organic beads and other materials, serve both local and international customers, create opportunities for local production, and build practical alternatives to plastic bands. The bigger idea is simple: sustainability should still feel beautiful.

We want people to keep the memory, not the plastic.

The ask

Bwiza Jewels is at the stage where support can make a real difference. I am not presenting a finished company and pretending everything is already solved. I am presenting a prototype, a market idea and a clear direction for what it can become.

With the right mentorship, connections and funding, I want to test the market, improve the product, build the first real Bwiza Jewels collection and learn how to turn a handmade idea into a sustainable business.

BWIZA JEWELS

Culture Natural Materials Design Technology